

# State Morphology

## Reference Sheet

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| <p><b>Large states</b></p> <p>Ex: Russia, US, Canada, China</p> <p>Pros: Vast diversity of resources</p> <p>Cons: difficult to protect, isolated/periphery areas may form separatist movements, higher likelihood of unequal development</p>                                          | <p><b>Compact states</b></p> <p>Ex: Poland, France</p> <p>Pros: easily manageable size (economics, defense, services), contributes to national unity</p> <p>Cons: size and/or geographic location may limit availability of natural resources</p>                                       |
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| <p><b>Elongated States</b></p> <p>EX: Chile, Italy, Malaysia, Vietnam</p> <p>Pros: variety of climates and resources</p> <p>Cons: Difficult to protect, isolated areas more likely to form separatist movements</p>                                                                   | <p><b>Perforated States</b></p> <p>EX: South Africa is perforated by Lesotho, Italy is perforated by Vatican City and San Marino</p> <p>Pros: similar to states of other similar shapes</p> <p>Cons: there is another country in the middle of their territory.</p>                     |
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| <p><b>Fragmented states</b></p> <p>EX: Philippines, Indonesia, Japan, US, UK</p> <p>Fragments can be separated by water or land</p> <p>Pros: access to transportation routes</p> <p>Cons: difficult to protect, isolated groups may form separatist movements, uneven development</p> | <p><b>Prorupted states</b></p> <p>Ex: Namibia, India, Democratic republic of Congo (arm stretches out, narrow extension of territory)</p> <p>Pros: provides access to resources/trade routes</p> <p>Cons: difficult to protect, other countries may claim, separatist groups likely</p> |

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| <p style="text-align: center;"><b>Micro states</b></p> <p style="text-align: center;">Tiny independent states.</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Ex: Vatican City, Monaco, San Marino</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Pros: relative location good (most in Europe), service-based economies</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Cons: limited resources and population, dependent on diplomacy since lack military strength</p>                                                           | <p style="text-align: center;"><b>Exclaves</b></p> <p style="text-align: center;">Separated from main state territory by land or water</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Ex: Alaska is an exclave of the US, Kaliningrad is an exclave of Russia</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Pros: resources and/or access to transportation routes</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Cons: difficult to protect, distance from main state territory, separatism, uneven development</p> |
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| <p style="text-align: center;"><b>Landlocked states</b></p> <p style="text-align: center;">Ex: Nepal, Chad, Switzerland, Bolivia</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Pros: no coastline to protect</p> <p style="text-align: center;">Cons: limited access to ocean for trade, possible lack of resources, dependent on diplomacy for trade routes. In a weaker political position than coastal countries (reason why Switzerland has been historically neutral in European politics/wars)</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

## Types of Boundary Disputes

- **Definitional** boundary disputes (aka **locational** boundary dispute): Two countries do not agree how to define the location of the boundary, leaving some territory contested between the two.
- **Operational** boundary dispute (aka **functional** boundary dispute): the two countries do not agree on how to administer the border, or who/what is allowed to cross.
- **Allocational** boundary disputes: two countries disagree over the allocation of resources that span the boundary zone (i.e., an underground oil field or aquifer, or a river from which both nations draw water).